

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Marketing English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For brand, product marketing, growth, content, SEO, lifecycle, demand generation, marketing operations, social, and agency teams.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

03 Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

05 Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

06 Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

07 Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A campaign brief targets "everyone who works in an office." The product is a scheduling tool, but the buyer and daily user may differ.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: Segment, ICP, Persona, JTBD.

Model response

Who decides to buy the tool, and who uses it each day? Let's define a specific audience and the problem we are solving before choosing the campaign message.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. A - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 · Conversations

1. The scheduling buyer may not be the user - The lesson's scheduling-tool brief targets everyone in an office; the buyer and daily user have not been identified.
2. One signup list contains two different needs - Separate fictional research exercise: event signups include office managers seeking room booking and recruiters seeking interview coordination; purchasing authority is unknown.

3. A productivity goal needs a named task - Separate fictional campaign intake: a team wants to promote a document tool as improving productivity, but no target task or desired behavior is specified.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A webinar audience with unverified buying roles

A fictional webinar attracted trainers and procurement staff. The next campaign must invite product demonstrations, but no one has checked which group uses the product or influences purchasing.

Role A: You plan the campaign. Ask about role and purpose before treating attendance as buying intent.

Role B: You own webinar research. Explain the known attendee groups and missing decision-role information.

Possible opening: We know who attended by job category, but not who uses the product or influences its purchase.

Success checks

- Distinguish attendance from purchase intent.
- Name both supplied attendee groups.
- Agree a focused question about user and buyer roles.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants to label every attendee a qualified buyer.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A draft advertisement says "the fastest tool on the market." The only evidence is an internal test against one earlier version.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: Positioning, Value proposition, Proof point, Brand promise.

Model response

The test supports a comparison with our earlier version, not the whole market. Could we use a narrower claim that accurately describes what we measured and send it for review?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. C - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. B - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 · Conversations

1. An earlier-version test cannot prove fastest in market - Separate fictional extension of the lesson: an internal test exported the same 100-row report in eight seconds on the new version and ten on the earlier version, on the same test machine. No market-wide or other-task comparison exists.
2. Three customer quotes are not universal experience - Separate fictional messaging review: three interviewees describe a tool as easy to learn; no broader usability study exists.
3. A feature exists, but the benefit is unmeasured - Separate fictional launch: a product adds reusable templates; no measured time-saving study has been conducted.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A pilot testimonial mentions an unsupported saving

A fictional pilot customer says they felt more organized. A draft testimonial caption translates that into saved ten hours weekly. No time measurement or customer statement supports the number.

Role A: You review brand claims. Explain the difference between the customer's statement and the invented caption.

Role B: You are the copywriter. Offer a bounded replacement based only on the supplied feedback.

Possible opening: The customer described feeling more organized; the ten-hour saving isn't in the evidence.

Success checks

- Reject the unsupported numerical claim.
- Preserve the customer's actual limited feedback.
- Offer revised wording for review without inventing permission to publish the quote.

Add a complication: A stakeholder asks you to keep the number because it makes the message concrete.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A launch brief has a date and channel list but no audience, approved message, or measure of success.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: Creative brief, GTM, Buyer journey, Sales enablement.

Model response

Could you add the primary audience, approved message, and success measure before Thursday's review? Those details will help the content and channel teams work toward the same outcome.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. B - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 • Conversations

1. A launch date is not a complete brief - The lesson's launch brief has a date and channels but lacks audience, approved message, and success measure.

2. Sales needs a demonstration question, not another banner - Separate fictional launch: sales has received campaign banners but no approved discovery questions for a new scheduling feature.

3. A localization request needs an approved source - Separate fictional GTM exercise: a localization lead receives two English message versions, neither marked approved, for a regional launch.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A launch rehearsal lacks a demonstration owner

A fictional launch rehearsal is planned, but no one owns the product demonstration. Marketing owns the introduction; product has not confirmed who can demonstrate the feature.

Role A: You coordinate the rehearsal. Request a named demonstration owner and availability confirmation.

Role B: You are the product lead. Clarify the demonstration scope before committing a presenter.

Possible opening: Could product confirm who can own the demonstration and what scope they can rehearse?

Success checks

- Separate the introduction from the product demonstration.
- Request scope and a confirmed owner.
- Keep presenter availability unconfirmed until checked.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks marketing to announce a presenter whose availability is still unknown.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A proposed article targets a popular keyword, but searchers appear to want instructions while the draft is a product announcement.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: Search intent, Keyword, SERP, Content brief.

Model response

The search intent appears to be instructional. Our draft announces a product instead. We could create a useful how-to article and include the product only where it helps answer the question.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. C - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. Instructions versus an announcement - The lesson's proposed article targets a keyword whose searchers appear to want instructions, while the draft announces a product.

2. A comparison query needs a comparison - Separate fictional editorial exercise: a draft targets 'tool A versus tool B' but describes only tool A; no tool B research has been completed.

3. An expert opinion is not a measured industry trend - Separate fictional thought-leadership draft: one internal expert predicts more asynchronous meetings; no industry dataset supports the prediction.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A definition page becomes a sales pitch

A fictional content brief targets 'What is a shared calendar?' The supplied meaning is a calendar that multiple authorized people can view to coordinate schedules; editing depends on permissions. The draft begins with three pricing paragraphs and never defines the term. No ranking result is supplied.

Role A: You are the editor. Explain the difference between answering a definition query and promoting a product.

Role B: You own the draft. Say a revised opening that explains a shared calendar using the supplied meaning, before any relevant product context.

Possible opening: The searcher is asking what the term means, but our opening discusses prices instead.

Success checks

- Identify the unanswered definition need.
- Propose an answer-first editorial sequence.
- Avoid promising a ranking or conversion result from the revision.

Add a complication: A stakeholder insists that answering the question would reduce sales opportunities.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

Paid conversions rose after a campaign change, but a discount began in the same week. A slide credits the campaign with the entire increase.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: Attribution, CPA, ROAS, Incrementality.

Model response

Conversions rose after the campaign change, but the discount is another possible influence. I'll describe the timing accurately and avoid claiming that the campaign caused the entire increase.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. C - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. B - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 • Conversations

1. The discount changed alongside the campaign - The lesson's paid conversions increased after a campaign change, while a discount began in the same week.

2. Lower CPA with a different conversion definition - Separate fictional reporting exercise: last month's CPA used purchases, while this month's uses trial signups. No purchase-based current CPA is supplied.

3. ROAS is not a profit calculation - Separate fictional campaign dataset: advertising spend is \$1,000 and attributed revenue is \$4,000; product costs, returns, and attribution validity are unassessed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An attribution window grows longer

A fictional platform's reported conversions rise after its attribution window changes from seven to thirty days. Campaign settings are otherwise unchanged in the supplied record. No incremental-sales study exists.

Role A: You are the performance analyst. Explain how the reporting change affects interpretation.

Role B: You are the campaign manager. Ask for a constant-window comparison before claiming improved effectiveness.

Possible opening: The attribution window expanded, so the increase may reflect which conversions are counted rather than new effectiveness.

Success checks

- Name the seven-to-thirty-day change.
- Avoid treating attributed growth as incremental sales.
- Agree a comparison using the same attribution window.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants to credit the higher total to creative improvements that were not made.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

CASE

A lead list is ready for sales. It contains contact details but no explanation of which contacts requested a conversation.

Teach this move

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

Vocabulary to check: MQL, SQL, Nurture, Suppression list.

Model response

The handoff needs the agreed qualification fields and contact permissions. I'll distinguish conversation requests from other activity so sales can choose an appropriate follow-up under our process.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Second-round challenge

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Language-check answers

1. B - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check. It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.
2. A - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct? This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

05 · Conversations

1. Contacts are not confirmed requests for calls - The lesson's lead list contains contact details but does not identify who requested a conversation.

2. A nurture handoff needs the actual last interaction - Separate fictional lifecycle exercise: three contacts attended a webinar and remain in nurture; no demo request is recorded.

3. A suppression flag stays visible at handoff - Separate fictional CRM handoff: one contact appears on a campaign list and a suppression list; the reason for suppression has not been checked.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A lead asks for a different follow-up channel

A fictional lead requested a product conversation by email, but the handoff summary says call requested. No phone-contact request is recorded.

Role A: You prepare the handoff. Correct the requested channel and state the available evidence.

Role B: You are the sales recipient. Confirm the channel and ask how the request is recorded.

Possible opening: The lead requested an email conversation; the call-request label is inaccurate.

Success checks

- Preserve the email request accurately.
- Do not invent permission for another channel.
- Confirm the corrected handoff and evidence reference.

Add a complication: A colleague says a phone call would be faster and wants to ignore the recorded preference.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

An email experiment records 120 clicks from 2,000 delivered messages in version A and 140 from 2,000 in version B. No significance analysis is complete.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: CTR, Lift test, Cohort, Vanity metric.

Model response

The observed click rates are 6% and 7%. Version B is higher in this sample, but we have not established whether the difference is reliable. Let's complete the planned analysis before naming a winner.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. A - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 • Conversations

1. One percentage point with significance still pending - The lesson's email test records A: 120 clicks from 2,000 deliveries; B: 140 from 2,000. Significance analysis is incomplete.

2. A cohort report with a shorter observation window - Separate fictional funnel report: one signup cohort has thirty days of follow-up, another only ten; final conversion comparison is pending.

3. A funnel count waits for duplicate review - Separate fictional analytics exercise: a dashboard counts 300 form submissions; duplicate-person checks have not been completed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A lift test has missing outcome data

A fictional lift test has complete exposure counts for both groups, but purchase outcomes for one day are missing. No final lift estimate is approved.

Role A: You are the experiment analyst. Report what is complete and the missing outcome period.

Role B: You own the executive update. Ask how to present the gap without treating missing purchases as zero.

Possible opening: Exposure counts are complete, but one day's purchase outcomes are missing from the analysis.

Success checks

- Separate complete exposure data from incomplete outcomes.
- Do not count missing outcomes as observed zeroes.
- Agree a qualified update and the required data check.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants a final lift number before the missing data is checked.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

CASE

A scheduled post includes a claim that reviewers have asked to revise. The post has not yet been published.

Teach this move

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Vocabulary to check: Substantiation, Material connection, Consent, Brand safety.

Model response

The scheduled wording differs from the reviewed claim. I'll pause publication through our process and send the revised copy for approval. Please confirm which version should replace it.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Second-round challenge

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Language-check answers

1. C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear. This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.
2. B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status. A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

05 • Conversations

1. Correcting a scheduled claim before publication - The lesson's scheduled post contains a claim reviewers asked to revise; it has not been published.

2. A creator relationship omitted from the brief - Separate fictional campaign exercise: a creator receives a free product, but the draft brief says there is no material connection. Nothing has been published.

3. An image-use assumption needs correction - Separate fictional marketing exercise: a draft uses a customer photo because it appeared on a public website; permission for this use has not been checked.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A response draft claims an investigation is complete

A fictional brand-response draft says a customer complaint has been fully investigated. The record shows only that the complaint was received; no review findings exist. The response is unsent.

Role A: You are the communications lead. Correct the unsupported completion claim.

Role B: You are the service reviewer. Explain what can be said now and what needs review before a further response.

Possible opening: We can confirm receipt of the complaint, but not a completed investigation or finding.

Success checks

- Separate receipt from investigation.
- Offer accurate acknowledgment wording without inventing a result.
- Keep the unsent status and next review step explicit.

Add a complication: A stakeholder wants to retain fully investigated to sound reassuring.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Marketing English

Professional audience: brand, product marketing, growth, content, SEO, lifecycle, demand generation, marketing operations, social, and agency teams

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Original fictional case: A campaign brief targets "everyone who works in an office." The product is a scheduling tool, but the buyer and daily user may differ.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: Segment: A meaningful subset of the market based on shared traits, needs, behavior, or value. / ICP: Ideal customer profile; the type of account or customer most likely to succeed and create value. / Persona: A model of a target user, buyer, or influencer used to guide messaging and content. / JTBD: Jobs to be done; what the customer is trying to accomplish in a situation.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Who decides to buy the tool, and who uses it each day? Let's define a specific audience and the problem we are solving before choosing the campaign message.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt this material for a teaching session

1. Ask me one brief planning question covering learner support needs, group size and available time. Offer a default of two B2 learners and 20 minutes. Stop and wait; use the default only if I choose it.
2. Create a timed plan using the supplied case or dialogue, its actual terminology and one narrow language goal. Include an individual first attempt, partner exchange, focused feedback and a retry. Keep the total within the time I choose. State what the learner should be able to communicate at the end.
3. Provide separate role cards for two or three professional speakers. Each card needs an objective, known information and one question to resolve. Label any invented private information as a variation; do not contradict shared facts. Do not place the model answer on the learner cards.
4. Add a B1 support option with useful frames, a B2 independent task and a C1 extension involving a plausible competing constraint. Maintain the same professional meaning across levels. Explain unfamiliar terms without removing the field's normal language. Include a workable solo alternative.
5. Put teacher notes and suggested responses in a clearly separate section after the learner material. Include likely misunderstandings and a short observation checklist for facts, clarity, tone and next step. Accept multiple successful formulations. Finish with one exit question and a delayed-recall task; identify what the teacher should check before use.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Marketing English

Professional audience: brand, product marketing, growth, content, SEO, lifecycle, demand generation, marketing operations, social, and agency teams

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Original fictional case: A campaign brief targets "everyone who works in an office." The product is a scheduling tool, but the buyer and daily user may differ.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: Segment: A meaningful subset of the market based on shared traits, needs, behavior, or value. / ICP: Ideal customer profile; the type of account or customer most likely to succeed and create value. / Persona: A model of a target user, buyer, or influencer used to guide messaging and content. / JTBD: Jobs to be done; what the customer is trying to accomplish in a situation.

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the language to the listener

1. Choose a short message or utterance from the reference and quote it exactly. Identify its purpose and likely audience. Ask me to choose a new audience: a close colleague, a decision-maker, or an external reader who may not know the jargon. Stop and wait.
2. Ask me to adapt that message for the chosen reader, keeping its facts and degree of certainty unchanged. Offer a short frame only if I request help. Wait for my attempt before showing alternatives.
3. Discuss at most three choices in my version: directness, specialist vocabulary and interpersonal tone. Explain when a direct request is clearer than extra politeness, and when an unfamiliar abbreviation needs expansion. Avoid cultural stereotypes or claims that one nationality always communicates a certain way.
4. Show two natural alternatives, such as a concise spoken version and a more explicit written version. Explain the tradeoff in each. Do not turn a request into an order, a possibility into a promise, or a pending decision into approval.
5. Ask me to respond to one realistic follow-up from the new reader, then wait. Finish by asking me to adapt the message for a second audience without losing its core meaning. Give feedback only after the attempt.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level